

DRAGON EVOLUTION BRANCHES, STATS, AND SKILLS

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Status: Product/design proposal for implementation planning

CONFIRMED DIRECTION

The game should feel like a cute hatchling growing into a mythical dragon.

Adventure scale should evolve with the dragon:

1. Hatchling - dungeon crawling
 - Small, cute, scrappy.
 - Encounters feel like cave rooms, ruins, tunnels, mushroom grottos, underground shrines.
2. Drake - forest adventuring
 - More confident and mobile.
 - Encounters feel like wild trails, monster dens, bandit camps, ancient groves.
3. Young Dragon - raiding towns
 - Dragon fantasy becomes more dominant.
 - Encounters include guards, watchtowers, caravans, town squares, treasure houses.
4. Dragon - raiding cities
 - Large-scale fantasy threat.
 - Encounters include city gates, battlements, guild halls, royal vaults, mage towers.
5. Ancient Dragon - mythical domination
 - Endgame identity.
 - Encounters become kingdoms, sky citadels, divine temples, rival ancient dragons, world bosses.

EVOLUTION TIMELINE TARGETS

Evolution pacing should create long-term attachment without making early progression feel stalled.

- Hatchling -> Drake: 2-4 hours
- Drake -> Young Dragon: 3-7 days
- Young Dragon -> Dragon: about 1 month
- Dragon -> Ancient Dragon: 3-6 months

Design implication:

- Hatchling and Drake need frequent visible progress.
- Young Dragon is where build identity becomes serious.
- Dragon is the long midgame prestige goal.
- Ancient Dragon is aspirational/endgame and can support very rare materials, long quest chains, and seasonal progression.

BATTLE SCREEN DIRECTION

Battle chapters should focus almost entirely on combat.

Required battle screen elements:

- Dragon HP bar
- Enemy/boss HP bar
- Roguelike experience bar for the current chapter/run
- Level-up moment offering 3 skill choices
- Skill choices from both:
 - general skill pool
 - evolution/element-specific skill pool
- Info button for:
 - current stat profile
 - selected skills
 - active passives/status effects
 - evolution branch identity

Recommended layout:

- Top: chapter/battle progress, enemy name/type, enemy HP
- Center: large battle scene with dragon and enemy taking most of the screen
- Bottom: dragon HP, roguelike XP bar, skill icons/status row
- Corner: compact info button, pause/settings/reduced-motion if needed

STAT MODEL

Stats should be readable, impactful, and visually expressed in battle.

Core Stats

- HP - survivability; visible as dragon health bar.
- Attack - base damage for claws, bite, tail, and many skills.
- Defense - flat/percent damage reduction; visible via smaller incoming numbers.
- Speed - turn frequency, attack cadence, and some dodge/initiative checks.

Offensive Build Stats

- Crit Chance - chance for critical hit.
- Crit Damage - critical damage multiplier.
- Combo Chance - chance to add an extra hit after an attack.
- Skill Damage - boosts active/passive skill effects.
- Breath Damage - boosts elemental breath attacks.
- Element Damage - boosts fire/water/earth/light/dark effects.

Defensive Build Stats

- Block Chance - chance to reduce incoming damage.
- Block Power - amount reduced when block triggers.
- Dodge Chance - chance to avoid an attack entirely.
- Damage Reduction - general percent mitigation.
- Shield Power - amount of temporary barrier gained from skills.
- Healing Received - improves healing effects.

Proc / Identity Stats

- Burn Chance / Burn Damage - fire damage over time.
- Soak Chance - water debuff that increases lightning/frost/impact effects if those are added later.
- Thorn Chance / Thorn Damage - earth retaliation.
- Radiance Chance - light-triggered heal/crit/blind effects.
- Curse Chance - dark-triggered weakness/drain/execute effects.
- Rage Generation - fills ultimate meter faster.
- Loot/Hoard Bonus - gold/material/relic reward scaling.

VISUAL FEEDBACK RULES

Every important stat should show up in battle.

- Crit: bigger damage number, sharp flash, hit-stop, burst.
- Block: scale/shield flash, reduced incoming number, "BLOCK".
- Dodge: wing hop/slide, miss text, enemy whiff animation.
- Speed: visibly faster attack cadence or initiative ticks.
- Combo: rapid second claw/bite hit with "COMBO".
- Counter: tail swipe after enemy hit.
- Lifesteal/drain: green or purple healing number returning to dragon.
- Shield: visible temporary barrier on HP bar.
- Rage: glowing meter and dramatic ultimate trigger.
- Element procs: persistent icons/effects on enemies.

EVOLUTION ARCHITECTURE

REQUESTED BRANCH SHAPE

Start with 5 egg elements:

1. Fire

2. Water
3. Earth
4. Light
5. Dark

Each egg evolves as:

- Hatchling: 1 starting element identity
- Drake: choose 1 of 3 paths
- Young Dragon: each Drake path splits into 2 paths
- Dragon: each Young Dragon path splits into 2 paths
- Ancient Dragon: each Dragon path splits into 2 final paths

This creates:

- 5 Hatchlings
- 15 Drake paths
- 30 Young Dragon paths
- 60 Dragon paths
- 120 Ancient Dragon capstones

Implementation recommendation:

- Do not hand-build 120 fully unique systems immediately.
- Build a scalable tag system:
 - egg element
 - drake archetype
 - young specialization
 - dragon mastery
 - ancient capstone
- Let each tier add a small number of stats, skill tags, passives, and visual traits.
- This makes 120 end states possible without requiring 120 bespoke combat engines.

STARTING EGGS

FIRE EGG - EMBER HATCHLING

Fantasy: playful baby fire dragon learning to control flame.

Base stat lean:

- High Attack
- Medium HP
- Low Defense
- Medium Speed
- Early Burn Chance

Starter skills:

- Spark Bite: basic attack has a small chance to Burn.
- Tiny Flame Breath: breath attack deals fire damage to one enemy.
- Warm Scales: small resistance to damage while Burn is active on an enemy.

Early feel:

- Aggressive, flashy, slightly fragile.
- Best for players who like damage, explosions, and big crits.

WATER EGG - TIDE HATCHLING

Fantasy: cute slippery dragon with bubbles, mist, and healing water.

Base stat lean:

- Medium Attack
- High HP
- Medium Defense
- Medium Speed
- Early Healing/Soak utility

Starter skills:

- Bubble Jet: water hit with a chance to Soak.
- Mist Mend: small self-heal after several turns.
- Slippery Scales: tiny Dodge boost while above half HP.

Early feel:

- Durable, forgiving, sustain-oriented.
- Best for players who like healing, control, and safe progression.

EARTH EGG - MOSS HATCHLING

Fantasy: stout little dragon with stone scales, roots, and stubborn defense.

Base stat lean:

- Medium Attack
- High HP
- High Defense
- Low Speed
- Early Block/Thorns

Starter skills:

- Pebble Slam: earth hit with bonus damage if the dragon blocked recently.
- Stone Snout: chance to Block incoming damage.
- Briar Scales: blocked hits can return small thorn damage.

Early feel:

- Tanky, steady, chunky.
- Best for players who like shields, defense, and retaliation.

LIGHT EGG - DAWN HATCHLING

Fantasy: radiant hatchling with holy sparkle, courage, and lucky bursts.

Base stat lean:

- Medium Attack
- Medium HP
- Medium Defense
- High Crit support
- Light healing/blind utility

Starter skills:

- Gleam Claw: attack with increased Crit Chance.
- Guiding Glow: small heal or shield after leveling up during a run.
- Flashburst: chance to Blind/interrupt an enemy attack.

Early feel:

- Heroic, lucky, clean, bursty-supportive.
- Best for players who like crits, clutch saves, and radiant effects.

DARK EGG - UMBRAL HATCHLING

Fantasy: mischievous shadow baby dragon that drains, curses, and hides.

Base stat lean:

- Medium Attack
- Medium HP
- Low Defense
- High Dodge/Drain potential
- Early Curse/Lifesteal

Starter skills:

- Shadow Nibble: small lifesteal attack.
- Creeping Curse: chance to reduce enemy Attack.

- Fade Step: small Dodge boost after taking damage.

Early feel:

- Sneaky, risky, snowbally.
- Best for players who like drain, curses, executes, and evasive builds.

DRAKE PATHS

Each hatchling should choose one of three Drake paths after roughly 2-4 hours.

Each Drake path should feel like the first real identity choice.

FIRE -> DRAKE PATHS

1. Flame Drake

Role: direct fire damage and Burn.

Stat lean:

- Attack +++
- Breath Damage ++
- Burn Chance ++
- Defense -

Signature passive:

- Kindled Hunger: Burned enemies take increased damage from bite/claw attacks.

Skill pool examples:

- Flame Fan: breath hits all enemies lightly.
- Searing Bite: bite refreshes Burn duration.
- Ash Snack: heal a little when a Burned enemy dies.

Young Dragon split:

- Inferno Young Dragon: Burn stacking and explosions.
- Volcanic Young Dragon: slower, heavier fire hits with armor melt.

2. Smoke Drake

Role: evasion, blind, dodge-counter.

Stat lean:

- Speed ++
- Dodge ++
- Crit Chance +
- HP -

Signature passive:

- Smoke Veil: after dodging, next attack has bonus Crit Chance.

Skill pool examples:

- Cinder Dash: dodge grants a small fire counter.
- Blinding Smoke: chance to make enemy attacks miss.
- Backdraft: dodging can trigger a weak breath attack.

Young Dragon split:

- Ashen Young Dragon: dodge, blind, evasive attrition.
- Cinderfang Young Dragon: dodge into crit/combo aggression.

3. Magma Drake

Role: bruiser, fire + earth durability.

Stat lean:

- HP ++
- Defense ++
- Attack +
- Speed -

Signature passive:

- Molten Scales: blocked hits can Burn the attacker.

Skill pool examples:

- Lava Hide: gain shield when applying Burn.
- Molten Slam: heavy attack that scales with Defense.
- Cracked Ground: chance to slow enemy Speed.

Young Dragon split:

- Lava Young Dragon: tanky Burn and shields.
- Obsidian Young Dragon: block, thorns, anti-crit armor.

WATER -> DRAKE PATHS

1. Tide Drake

Role: sustain and steady water damage.

Stat lean:

- HP ++
- Healing ++
- Breath Damage +
- Crit -

Signature passive:

- Flow State: every few turns, heal a small percent of missing HP.

Skill pool examples:

- Tidal Breath: water breath applies Soak.
- Renewing Mist: heal after level-up skill picks.
- Undertow: Soaked enemies lose Speed.

Young Dragon split:

- River Young Dragon: healing, cleansing, survivability.
- Wavecrash Young Dragon: water burst and knockback-style control.

2. Frost Drake

Role: shields, slow, freeze control.

Stat lean:

- Defense ++
- Shield Power ++
- Control ++
- Speed -

Signature passive:

- Rime Guard: gain shield when slowing or freezing an enemy.

Skill pool examples:

- Frost Breath: chance to Slow.
- Ice Shell: shield at battle start.
- Shatter: crits deal bonus damage to Slowed enemies.

Young Dragon split:

- Glacier Young Dragon: massive shields and freeze.
- Hailstorm Young Dragon: multi-hit frost shards and crit-shatter.

3. Mist Drake

Role: dodge, healing, evasive utility.

Stat lean:

- Dodge ++
- Speed ++
- Healing +
- Attack -

Signature passive:

- Vapor Form: first lethal hit in a run can leave the dragon at 1 HP with a mist shield. Long cooldown.

Skill pool examples:

- Mist Step: Dodge grants healing.
- Fog Bank: reduce enemy accuracy.
- Hidden Current: after dodging, next breath applies Soak.

Young Dragon split:

- Cloud Young Dragon: evasive support and blinds.
- Mirage Young Dragon: dodge into counter/crit illusions.

EARTH -> DRAKE PATHS

1. Stone Drake

Role: pure defense and block.

Stat lean:

- Defense +++
- Block Chance ++
- HP ++
- Speed --

Signature passive:

- Stonewall: block cannot reduce damage below a useful minimum, but always triggers a visible shield flash.

Skill pool examples:

- Granite Guard: increase Block Power.
- Heavy Tail: counterattack after blocking.
- Fortify: gain Defense each battle, capped for the run.

Young Dragon split:

- Mountain Young Dragon: maximum tank, shields, boss survival.
- Ironhide Young Dragon: block/counter specialist.

2. Thorn Drake

Role: retaliation and bleed/poison-like nature damage.

Stat lean:

- HP ++
- Thorn Damage ++
- Counter ++
- Speed -

Signature passive:

- Briar Back: enemies that hit the dragon take thorn damage.

Skill pool examples:

- Root Snare: chance to slow enemies after countering.
- Bramble Armor: thorns scale with Defense.
- Splinter Bite: attacks increase thorn damage taken by the target.

Young Dragon split:

- Briar Young Dragon: thorns, roots, attrition.
- Venomroot Young Dragon: poison/debuff hybrid.

3. Crystal Drake

Role: defense plus crit/reflection.

Stat lean:

- Defense ++
- Crit Damage ++
- Reflect +
- HP +

Signature passive:

- Prism Scales: blocked hits charge the next crit or breath.

Skill pool examples:

- Crystal Spike: crits pierce some Defense.
- Prismatic Guard: shield reflects a percent of damage.
- Shard Burst: shield break damages enemy.

Young Dragon split:

- Gem Young Dragon: crit/reflect hybrid.
- Prism Young Dragon: elemental amplification and skill damage.

LIGHT -> DRAKE PATHS

1. Dawn Drake

Role: healing, shields, safe progression.

Stat lean:

- Healing ++
- Shield Power ++
- HP +
- Attack -

Signature passive:

- First Light: once per battle, falling below 30% HP grants a shield and heal.

Skill pool examples:

- Sunbeam: light breath with bonus vs cursed/dark enemies.
- Hope Spark: heal when choosing a skill.
- Radiant Guard: shield improves Crit Chance briefly.

Young Dragon split:

- Solar Young Dragon: healing and radiant damage.
- Guardian Young Dragon: shields, protection, revive-lite effects.

2. Stormlight Drake

Role: crit, speed, radiant lightning.

Stat lean:

- Speed ++

- Crit Chance ++
- Combo +
- Defense -

Signature passive:

- Flashpoint: crits can trigger a small chain-light burst.

Skill pool examples:

- Lightning Gleam: crits deal bonus light damage.
- Quick Halo: Speed increases Crit Chance slightly.
- Triple Spark: combo hits build Radiance.

Young Dragon split:

- Tempest Young Dragon: speed/combo/lightning.
- Star Young Dragon: crit damage and radiant bursts.

3. Sacred Drake

Role: anti-dark, cleanse, boss resilience.

Stat lean:

- Defense +
- Healing +
- Skill Damage ++
- Crit +

Signature passive:

- Consecration: bosses deal slightly reduced damage while Radiance is active.

Skill pool examples:

- Cleanse Flame: remove a debuff and heal.
- Judgment Bite: bonus damage to elites/bosses.
- Sacred Aura: periodic shield pulse.

Young Dragon split:

- Seraph Young Dragon: cleanse, revive, radiant aura.
- Judgment Young Dragon: boss damage and execution thresholds.

DARK -> DRAKE PATHS

1. Shadow Drake

Role: dodge, crit, stealth strikes.

Stat lean:

- Dodge ++
- Crit Chance ++
- Speed +
- Defense -

Signature passive:

- From the Dark: after dodging, next hit deals bonus dark damage.

Skill pool examples:

- Night Slash: crits apply Curse.
- Fade: gain Dodge after taking damage.
- Ambush Bite: first attack in battle has high Crit Chance.

Young Dragon split:

- Night Young Dragon: dodge/crit assassin.
- Voidstep Young Dragon: dodge/teleport/counter magic.

2. Blood Drake

Role: lifesteal, self-damage risk, drain.

Stat lean:

- Lifesteal +++
- Attack ++
- HP +
- Defense -

Signature passive:

- Blood Feast: overhealing can become a temporary shield.

Skill pool examples:

- Drain Bite: lifesteal attack.
- Crimson Pact: spend HP for bonus damage.
- Predator Rush: killing an enemy grants Speed briefly.

Young Dragon split:

- Vampiric Young Dragon: heavy lifesteal and sustain.
- Ravager Young Dragon: high-risk self-damage burst.

3. Curse Drake

Role: debuffs, damage over time, execute.

Stat lean:

- Skill Damage ++
- Curse Chance ++
- Boss Control +
- Speed -

Signature passive:

- Hex Mark: cursed enemies take increasing damage from repeated hits.

Skill pool examples:

- Weakening Hex: reduce enemy Attack.
- Doom Whisper: low-health enemies take bonus damage.
- Soul Tax: enemies lose HP when they buff or attack.

Young Dragon split:

- Hex Young Dragon: layered curses and debuffs.
- Reaper Young Dragon: execute thresholds and soul gain.

YOUNG DRAGON, DRAGON, AND ANCIENT STRUCTURE

Because the full tree reaches 120 ancient endings, use a repeatable specialization model.

Each Drake path splits into two Young Dragon paths:

- One path should intensify the obvious fantasy.
- One path should hybridize or twist it.

Each Young Dragon splits into two Dragon paths:

- One path should be reliable/scaling.
- One path should be explosive/risky/specialized.

Each Dragon splits into two Ancient Dragon capstones:

- One path should be the majestic/mythic mastery version.
- One path should be the dangerous/legendary/forbidden version.

EXAMPLE FULL BRANCHES

Fire Example: Flame Drake -> Inferno Young Dragon

Dragon split:

1. Wildfire Dragon

- Build: spreading Burn, multi-enemy fights, mob clearing.
- Stats: Burn Damage, Combo, Breath Damage.
- Skills:
 - Wildfire Spread: Burn can jump to another enemy.
 - Kindling Combo: combo hits deal bonus damage to Burning enemies.

Ancient split:

- Ancient Phoenixfire Dragon
 - Safer capstone: Burn heals the dragon slightly when enemies fall.
 - Theme: rebirth, radiant flame, survivability.
- Ancient Worldfire Dragon
 - Dangerous capstone: Burn can stack very high and explode, but defensive stats are lower.
 - Theme: apocalypse flame.

2. Hellflare Dragon

- Build: huge breath attacks and boss melting.
- Stats: Breath Damage, Crit Damage, Rage Generation.
- Skills:
 - Hellflare Breath: ultimate breath consumes Burn stacks for burst damage.
 - Furnace Heart: rage fills faster while enemies are Burning.

Ancient split:

- Ancient Sun-Eater Dragon
 - Mythic mastery: massive breath, self-shield after ultimate.
- Ancient Calamity Dragon
 - Forbidden mastery: extreme boss damage, self-overheat risk.

Water Example: Frost Drake -> Glacier Young Dragon

Dragon split:

1. Icewall Dragon

- Build: shields, freeze, boss survival.
- Stats: Shield Power, Defense, Freeze Chance.
- Skills:
 - Glacier Wall: shield grows when enemy is slowed.
 - Permafrost: freeze lasts longer on elites/bosses, but at reduced strength.

Ancient split:

- Ancient Crown-Glacier Dragon
 - Mythic mastery: nearly unbreakable shield cycles.
- Ancient Absolute-Zero Dragon

- Forbidden mastery: freeze-control focus with lower damage.

2. Shatterstorm Dragon

- Build: frost crits and shard explosions.
- Stats: Crit Chance, Crit Damage, Skill Damage.
- Skills:
 - Shatter Crit: crits against slowed enemies burst for AoE frost damage.
 - Hail Barrage: combo hits launch frost shards.

Ancient split:

- Ancient Aurora Dragon
 - Majestic mastery: balanced crits, shields, and visual spectacle.
- Ancient Whiteout Dragon
 - Dangerous mastery: high crit storm, lower sustain.

Earth Example: Stone Drake -> Mountain Young Dragon

Dragon split:

1. Titanhide Dragon

- Build: pure tank, block, boss endurance.
- Stats: HP, Defense, Block Power.
- Skills:
 - Titanhide: damage cannot exceed a percent of max HP from normal hits.
 - Immovable: blocking charges a heavy tail counter.

Ancient split:

- Ancient Worldback Dragon
 - Majestic mastery: enormous HP/Defense and team/companion protection later.
- Ancient Mountain-Eater Dragon
 - Dangerous mastery: converts Defense into damage, slower but devastating.

2. Quake Dragon

- Build: slow heavy hits, stun/interrupt, defense-scaling damage.
- Stats: Defense, Attack, Counter.
- Skills:
 - Quake Stomp: heavy hit can interrupt enemy action.
 - Faultline: every block increases next earth attack.

Ancient split:

- Ancient Earthshaker Dragon
 - Mythic mastery: reliable quake control.
- Ancient Cataclysm Dragon
 - Forbidden mastery: huge delayed damage and self-slow.

Light Example: Stormlight Drake -> Tempest Young Dragon

Dragon split:

1. Thunderhalo Dragon

- Build: speed, crit, chain light bursts.
- Stats: Speed, Crit Chance, Combo.
- Skills:
 - Thunderhalo: every third crit chains radiant lightning.
 - Bright Tempo: Speed increases roguelike XP gain slightly after battles.

Ancient split:

- Ancient Starstorm Dragon
 - Majestic mastery: radiant chain-lightning spectacle.
- Ancient Heavenpiercer Dragon
 - Dangerous mastery: extreme crit burst, fragile if unlucky.

2. Comet Dragon

- Build: huge crit damage and ultimate impacts.
- Stats: Crit Damage, Rage Generation, Skill Damage.
- Skills:
 - Cometfall: ultimate deals bonus damage based on crit stats.
 - Radiant Impact: crits build ultimate charge.

Ancient split:

- Ancient Celestial Dragon
 - Mythic mastery: balanced crit/rage/heal.
- Ancient Judgment Star Dragon
 - Forbidden mastery: boss-execution light damage.

Dark Example: Blood Drake -> Vampiric Young Dragon

Dragon split:

1. Nightfeast Dragon

- Build: lifesteal sustain, kill chaining.
- Stats: Lifesteal, Attack, Speed.
- Skills:
 - Nightfeast: kills grant temporary attack speed and healing.
 - Blood Shield: overhealing becomes shield.

Ancient split:

- Ancient Crimson Moon Dragon
 - Majestic/dark mastery: sustain monster with moonlit visuals.
- Ancient Devourer Dragon
 - Forbidden mastery: execute and consume enemies for scaling power.

2. Bloodrage Dragon

- Build: self-damage, rage, burst.
- Stats: Attack, Rage Generation, Crit Damage.
- Skills:
 - Bloodrage: spending HP grants rage.
 - Ravenous Crit: crits heal more when below half HP.

Ancient split:

- Ancient Sanguine Dragon

- Mythic mastery: controlled blood magic, sustain/burst balance.
- Ancient Abyssal Hunger Dragon
- Dangerous mastery: extreme damage at low HP.

GENERAL ROGUELIKE SKILL POOL

These can appear for any evolution path.

COMMON SKILLS

- Tough Scales: +Max HP.
- Sharpened Claws: +Attack.
- Guarded Stance: +Defense.
- Quick Wings: +Speed.
- Lucky Bite: +Crit Chance.
- Heavy Fangs: +Crit Damage.
- Second Swipe: +Combo Chance.
- Scale Block: +Block Chance.
- Wing Dodge: +Dodge Chance.
- Treasure Nose: +Gold/loot from this run.

RARE SKILLS

- Rage Spark: gain more ultimate meter.
- Battle Snack: heal after each fight.
- Boss Grudge: bonus damage to elites/bosses.
- Finisher: bonus damage to low-HP enemies.
- Momentum: winning quickly grants Speed for the next battle.
- Thick Hide: reduce all incoming damage by a small percent.
- Veteran Instinct: first hit in each battle has increased Crit Chance.

EPIC SKILLS

- Dragon Fury: unlock or enhance a temporary ultimate.
- Hoard Fever: rewards improve, but enemies hit slightly harder.
- Last Stand: below 30% HP, gain Attack and Defense.
- Perfect Guard: first block each battle negates extra damage.
- Predator Chain: defeating an enemy grants an immediate follow-up attack.
- Elemental Awakening: increases current evolution element effects.

ELEMENT SKILL POOLS

FIRE SKILLS

- Burning Breath: breath applies Burn.
- Wildfire: Burn can spread.
- Explosive Ash: Burned enemies explode on death.
- Molten Claws: attacks against Burning enemies deal bonus damage.
- Furnace Heart: Burn ticks grant rage.

WATER SKILLS

- Soaking Breath: apply Soak.
- Renewing Mist: periodic healing.
- Tidal Pull: Soaked enemies lose Speed.
- Bubble Shield: gain shield after water skills.
- Deep Current: healing also boosts next attack.

EARTH SKILLS

- Stone Guard: increased Block Power.
- Briar Scales: attackers take thorn damage.
- Root Snare: chance to slow after being hit.
- Quake Tail: counterattacks can stun/interrupt.
- Crystal Shell: shield reflects damage.

LIGHT SKILLS

- Radiant Claw: increased Crit Chance.
- Guiding Glow: heal/shield after level-up.
- Blinding Flash: chance to make enemy miss.
- Judgment: bonus damage to elites/bosses.
- Halo Burst: crits create small radiant AoE.

DARK SKILLS

- Drain Bite: lifesteal.
- Creeping Curse: reduce enemy Attack.
- Fade Step: Dodge after taking damage.
- Soul Mark: repeated hits increase damage taken.
- Execute: bonus damage to low-HP enemies.

RECOMMENDED FIRST IMPLEMENTATION SLICE

Do not try to implement the full tree first.

First playable slice:

1. Five selectable eggs:
 - Fire, Water, Earth, Light, Dark
2. Hatchling battle screen focus:
 - dragon HP bar
 - enemy HP bar
 - roguelike XP bar
 - level-up 3-skill pick
 - info button for stats and selected skills
3. One Drake choice preview per element:
 - show the three future Drake paths, locked until evolution
4. First dungeon-crawling chapter theme:
 - rooms/fights/treasures/shrines/boss
5. Implement only enough stats to prove impact:
 - HP, Attack, Defense, Speed
 - Crit Chance, Crit Damage
 - Block Chance, Dodge Chance
 - one element proc per egg

Success criteria:

- Player understands their chosen egg identity within 2 minutes.
- Battles take most of the screen and feel active.
- Leveling during a run creates a clear 3-choice roguelike moment.
- Stats and skills selected are visible from the info button.
- The first Drake evolution preview makes the player want to keep playing.

OPEN DESIGN QUESTIONS

These can be answered later; implementation should not block on them yet.

- Should players own one dragon at a time or collect multiple dragons?
- Can eggs/evolution branches be changed later, or are they permanent per dragon?
- Should Ancient Dragon be one final choice or allow prestige into a new egg cycle?
- Should Light/Dark be rarer unlocks or equal starter eggs? Current direction says all five are starter eggs.
- Should skill choices be purely random, weighted by branch tags, or include rerolls?

IMPLEMENTATION GUARDRAILS

- Keep first build data-driven.
- Use tags for skills/evolutions instead of hardcoding every branch.
- Add automation that verifies:
 - five egg options exist
 - each egg has three Drake paths
 - battle screen exposes HP, XP, 3 skill choices, info button
 - stat profile includes the agreed stat names
 - skill picks are stored and visible
- Avoid adding monetization UI during this slice.
- Avoid hiding core battle behind map UI; battle is the main screen for chapters.